



“JOB CREATION IS A MULTI-STAKEHOLDER INITIATIVE”

The Budget has a whole-of-government approach geared towards employment, says Labour Secretary Sumita Dawra

BY **SURABHI**

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SUMITA DAWRA, SECRETARY in the Ministry of Labour & Employment, believes that the employment-linked initiative (ELI) schemes—Scheme A for first-timers, Scheme B for job creation in manufacturing, and Scheme C that entails support to employers for additional employment—along with an upgrade of 1,000 ITIs, and internships for 10 million youth in the Top 500 companies, will boost job creation. This has been a key ask of the industry, and the Budget has a number of growth drivers that will generate employment, she says. Edited excerpts:



The main focus of the Budget this time has been the ELI schemes. Could you elaborate on these?

The Budget gives a lot of detail. The three schemes will ride on the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) and also align with the existing work of EPFO, except for one or two new



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elements like the direct benefit transfers under Scheme A. The EPFO is already in the process of upgrading its hardware and software. We are working on the schemes, and we should be ready with the draft in a few weeks. Then

there has to be inter-ministerial consultation, after which it will go to the Expenditure Finance Committee (EFC) and then to the cabinet for approval. We hope that we will be able to deal with all these procedural aspects by the end of this year.